

MSP | MSP-07

# Benefits Realisation Plan

Schedule and governance for realising programme benefits

## Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

| Field               | Detail                         |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|
| Document title      | Benefits Realisation Plan      |
| Document reference  | MSP-07-HEL-T2-v1.0             |
| Project / Programme | Programme Helios               |
| Version             | 1.0                            |
| Status              | Baselined                      |
| Date                | 18 Sep 2026                    |
| Author              | D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager  |
| Owner               | Business Change Manager        |
| Approver            | Programme Board                |
| Classification      | Internal                       |
| Retention           | 7 years from programme closure |

## Document control

### Version history

| Version | Date        | Author                        | Summary of change                        |
|---------|-------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 0.1     | 04 Jun 2026 | D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager | Initial draft                            |
| 0.2     | 21 Jul 2026 | D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager | Updated following workstream lead review |
| 1.0     | 18 Sep 2026 | D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager | Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate  |

### Reviewers

| Name                                   | Role                     | Review scope                              | Date reviewed |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------|
| T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect  | Chief Platform Architect | Technical content and solution alignment  | 08 Sep 2026   |
| L. Haddad, CISO                        | CISO                     | Security, assurance and residency content | 10 Sep 2026   |
| C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner | Finance Business Partner | Cost, funding and benefit figures         | 11 Sep 2026   |
| M. Verity, Head of P3O                 | Head of P3O              | Governance standards and completeness     | 15 Sep 2026   |

### Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

| Name                                   | Role                                 | Decision                               | Date        |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO              | Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO | Approved                               | 18 Sep 2026 |
| H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure | Director of Infrastructure           | Approved                               | 18 Sep 2026 |
| L. Haddad, CISO                        | CISO                                 | Approved subject to closure of ISS-003 | 18 Sep 2026 |

### Related products

| Reference | Product                  | Relationship          |
|-----------|--------------------------|-----------------------|
| MSP-06    | Benefit Profile          | Detail per benefit    |
| MSP-08    | Programme Plan           | Alignment of tranches |
| MSP-23    | Programme Closure Report | Handover point        |

## How to use this template

| Aspect             | Guidance                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Purpose            | Sets out when each benefit will be realised and measured, how realisation activities align to tranches, and who is accountable.                                                |
| Framework          | MSP — Justification theme; created in Define the Programme                                                                                                                     |
| Created when       | Define the Programme                                                                                                                                                           |
| Reviewed / updated | At each tranche boundary; handed to the business at closure                                                                                                                    |
| Owner              | Business Change Manager                                                                                                                                                        |
| Approver           | Programme Board                                                                                                                                                                |
| Format options     | Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.                                                                                  |
| Tailoring          | Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach. |

*This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.*

### Quality criteria

*Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.*

- Realisation is scheduled against tranches, not left to "after the programme"
- Benefit reviews are funded and resourced
- Ownership after programme closure is explicitly transferred and accepted
- The plan distinguishes when a benefit starts to accrue from when it is measured

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## 1. Scope and approach

*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*

## 2. Benefits realisation schedule

| Benefit ref | Benefit                                       | Enabled by (tranche) | Realisation starts | Full realisation | Owner                                  |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------|
| BEN-01      | Reduced external GPU rental spend             | Tranche 2            | From Q3 2027       | From Q3 2027     | V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement      |
| BEN-02      | Faster model training cycle time              | Tranche 1            | From Q2 2027       | From Q2 2027     | N. Ozturk, ML Platform Lead            |
| BEN-03      | Improved compute utilisation                  | Tranche 3            | From Q3 2027       | From Q3 2027     | P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead |
| BEN-04      | Reduced time to provision AI environments     | Tranche 2            | From Q3 2027       | From Q3 2027     | P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead |
| BEN-05      | Data residency and sovereignty assurance      | Tranche 1            | From Q3 2027       | From Q3 2027     | L. Haddad, CISO                        |
| BEN-06      | New revenue from AI-enabled products          | Tranche 3            | From FY29          | From FY29        | V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement      |
| BEN-07      | Reduced energy cost per unit of training work | Tranche 2            | From Q4 2027       | From Q4 2027     | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead          |
| BEN-08      | Retention of scarce AI engineering talent     | Tranche 1            | From FY28          | From FY28        | F. Mansour, Business Change Lead       |

## 3. Realisation by tranche

| Tranche   | Capabilities delivered | Benefits enabled                                        | Cumulative benefit value | Review point |
|-----------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------|
| Tranche 1 | Yes                    | Substitutes AED 14.3m of annual public cloud GPU rental | AED 11,200,000           | 15 Dec 2026  |
| Tranche 2 | Partially              | Removes four standing data residency                    | AED 240,000              | 30 Nov 2026  |

| Tranche   | Capabilities delivered | Benefits enabled                                                      | Cumulative benefit value | Review point |
|-----------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------|
|           |                        | <i>exceptions</i>                                                     |                          |              |
| Tranche 3 | Yes                    | Cuts environment provisioning from 23 working days to under two hours | AED 17,800,000           | 15 Oct 2026  |

#### 4. Benefit review schedule

| Review      | Date         | Benefits reviewed                         | Chaired by                             | Reports to                             |
|-------------|--------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 31 Jan 2027 | From Q3 2027 | Reduced external GPU rental spend         | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead          | C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner |
| 26 Feb 2027 | From Q2 2027 | Faster model training cycle time          | D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer     | R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO              |
| 31 Mar 2027 | From Q3 2027 | Improved compute utilisation              | L. Haddad, CISO                        | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead          |
| 23 Apr 2027 | From Q3 2027 | Reduced time to provision AI environments | E. Santos, Procurement Lead            | D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer     |
| 28 May 2027 | From Q3 2027 | Data residency and sovereignty assurance  | R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO              | L. Haddad, CISO                        |
| 25 Jun 2027 | From FY29    | New revenue from AI-enabled products      | P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead | E. Santos, Procurement Lead            |

#### 5. Baseline capture plan

| Benefit ref                                                 | Baseline measure        | Capture by                                                        | Owner                                  | Status      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------|
| Reduces median training cycle time from 11.5 days to 3 days | 1.62 PUE                | Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026 | V. Chandra, Product Management         | Open        |
| Removes four standing data residency exceptions             | 31% average utilisation | Aligned to the strategic theme of sovereign AI capability         | P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead | In progress |
| Cuts                                                        | AED 19.4m per year      | Carried forward                                                   | R. Al Mazrouei,                        | Complete    |

| Benefit ref                                                             | Baseline measure | Capture by                                      | Owner                       | Status      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------|
| <i>environment provisioning from 23 working days to under two hours</i> |                  | <i>from the Tranche 1 lessons register</i>      | Group CTO                   |             |
| <i>Improves PUE from 1.62 to 1.21 across the estate</i>                 | 11.5 days median | Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4 | E. Santos, Procurement Lead | Not started |

## 6. Business change activities

The embedding activities without which outputs will not convert to benefits — training, process adoption, decommissioning, behaviour change, incentive alignment.

| Ref   | Activity                                     | Benefits supported                                                    | Owner                         | Timing      | Status      |
|-------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------|-------------|
| A-010 | Complete hall B structural survey            | Cuts environment provisioning from 23 working days to under two hours | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead | 26 Feb 2027 | Open        |
| A-020 | Place structural strengthening order         | Removes four standing data residency exceptions                       | E. Santos, Procurement Lead   | 31 Jan 2027 | In progress |
| A-030 | Execute floor strengthening works            | Substitutes AED 14.3m of annual public cloud GPU rental               | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead | 15 Dec 2026 | Complete    |
| A-040 | Lodge utility uplift application             | Removes four standing data residency exceptions                       | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead | 30 Nov 2026 | Not started |
| A-050 | Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply | Substitutes AED 14.3m of annual public cloud GPU rental               | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead | 15 Oct 2026 | Open        |
| A-060 | Install CDUs and secondary cooling loop      | Removes four standing data residency exceptions                       | A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead | 18 Sep 2026 | In progress |
| A-070 | Build leaf-spine fabric in hall A            | Substitutes AED 14.3m of annual public cloud GPU rental               | J. Ferreira, Network Lead     | 25 Jun 2027 | Complete    |

## 7. Transition and readiness gates

| Gate                                                                            | Readiness criteria                                                                   | Assessed by                            | Date        | Outcome                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026                   | Median environment request-to-usable time under two hours across 20 sampled requests | R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO              | 25 Jun 2027 | Validated — no change required to the baseline               |
| Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above                        | All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs              | C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner | 28 May 2027 | Escalated to the Programme Board and resolved on 18 Sep 2026 |
| Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail | Independent penetration test closed with no open critical or high findings           | S. Bhatt, Project Manager              | 23 Apr 2027 | Closed with no residual exposure                             |
| Evidenced in the Tranche 2 gate pack, section 4                                 | Independent penetration test closed with no open critical or high findings           | V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement      | 31 Mar 2027 | Partially met — carried into PI 5 with reduced scope         |

## 8. Post-programme arrangements

Who continues to measure and report benefits after closure, under what governance, and for how long.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED 118,000,000. Detail is maintained by the Business Change Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.